

Employability Award (EA)

This course is designed to help our students be employment-ready when they leave sixth form, either for post-18 education, work or training. This course will primarily be undertaken by those students for whom a fourth academic subject in Year 12 may not be manageable. It will also appeal to those students who are likely to undertake employment or apprenticeships as a post-18 pathway rather than higher education, as they will receive extra support for applications and interviews and further develop their workplace skills.

This is not an externally accredited course, although employers highly value these types of course and the skills that they prove you have acquired. Similar courses are frequently run at university level and are highly successful.

By completing the Employability Award, you will have:

- Gained awareness of key employability skills and how to develop them.
- Started to gain these key skills.
- Gained some experience of a workplace, as well as the opportunity to hold a position of responsibility.
- Had experience of making a successful job/course application.
- Had experience of an interview and feedback on how to improve further.
- Gained skills in preparing and delivering a presentation.
- Been able to reflect on your progression on the Award and what skills need to be developed in the future.
- Gained a certificate to include in your CV/take to interviews.

What makes up the Employability Award?

There are five elements to be completed over the course of Year 12:

1. Ten skills workshops (online). This includes topics such as leadership, confidence, assertiveness, resilience, communication, interviews and job-seeking.
2. Three employability lectures (delivered by visiting speakers).
3. 20 hours of work experience/volunteering.
4. A mock Interview and feedback with an employer.
5. A short presentation to an audience of staff and employers to demonstrate what you have learned from undertaking the course.

This course will be completed by the end of June 2026, allowing students to focus on the transition to Year 13.

Any questions; please email Mrs Ball, Careers Adviser and Coordinator, at cball@backwellschool.net

